



On the beach

A coconut can travel long distances by sea, until it is washed up onto the shore. In the warm sand, it sprouts and starts to grow.

The coconut contains liquid, so the seedling has its own water supply for a while.

The stem is formed from the stalks of the leaves.

Inside the bean, you can see the part that is the future root.

Roots and shoots

When the soil gets warm in spring, this broad bean germinates and begins to grow.

Eggshells



Seeds



Damp cotton balls



Fast food

Mustard and watercress seeds are quick and easy to grow. Put some damp cotton balls in clean egg shells and sprinkle a few seeds on top. Look at the seeds each day and keep the cotton balls damp. In about 10 days you will have your own home-grown salad!



Some like it hot

Some seeds must literally go through fire and water before they can germinate. In the arid Australian outback, fierce fires can rip across the land. They awaken the dormant seeds of these acacia trees.



As the shoot gets longer and thicker, the first leaves open.

The shoot appears above ground. This is the stem.

A first sign of life—the root pushes through the skin of the bean.

